1. How do people currently remember things?

People rarely rely on a single system. Instead, they build multiple external memory systems to compensate for forgetting.

The most common methods observed were:

- Taking screenshots
- Creating phone reminders
- Using Google/Apple Calendar
- Writing notes (physical or digital)
- Sending messages to themselves
- Starring emails
- Pinning chats
- Voice notes
- Sticky notes and whiteboards
- Smart assistants (Alexa, Google Home)
- Airtags and location-based reminders

Rather than lacking tools, users struggle because these systems are fragmented and require constant maintenance.

2. What do they forget most?

The forgotten items generally fall into two categories:

Personal commitments

- Birthdays
- Plans with friends
- Conversations
- Things they promised to do
- Family updates
- Important messages

Operational information

- Appointments
- Meetings
- Deadlines
- Subscription renewals
- Bills
- Flight details
- Important screenshots
- Emails requiring action
- Everyday objects (keys, wallet, phone)

A common pattern is that the information originally exists in another app (e.g., WhatsApp or Gmail) but is never transferred into a reliable memory system.

3. Why don’t existing apps work?

The research suggests that existing productivity apps are not failing because of missing features, but because they introduce additional cognitive effort.

Most apps expect users to:

1. Recognize that something is important.
2. Stop what they are currently doing.
3. Open another application.
4. Decide where the information belongs.
5. Categorize and organize it.
6. Continue maintaining that system.

For many ADHD users, this organizational overhead becomes another task to manage.

Additionally:

- Productivity apps begin **after** information has already been captured.
- Information is scattered across communication apps, emails, screenshots, and notes.
- Users frequently abandon productivity systems because maintaining them becomes mentally exhausting.

4. Would they actually use Share → Second?

The research strongly suggests that users are already performing behaviors that closely resemble the proposed interaction.

Current workarounds include:

- Taking screenshots to remember information
- Sending messages to themselves
- Starring emails
- Pinning chats
- Copying information into notes or reminder apps

These behaviors indicate that users are already willing to take a small intentional action to preserve important information.

The proposed **Share → Second** workflow simply replaces multiple fragmented workflows with a single, consistent destination.

However, adoption depends on three conditions:

- **Trust:** Users must know that Second only stores information they explicitly choose to share.
- **Speed:** Sharing must be faster than creating a reminder manually.

- **Value:** Second must immediately organize the shared information into useful outputs such as reminders, calendar events, subscription tracking, or a searchable memory vault.

The current research therefore supports the hypothesis that users are likely to adopt the interaction model, provided it remains privacy-first and requires minimal effort.

Overall Conclusion

The research validates four important assumptions:

- People already rely on external memory systems.
- Important information originates across many different apps.
- Existing productivity tools solve organization, not information capture.
- Users already perform an intentional “save this for later” action through screenshots, self-messages, starred emails, and similar workarounds.

Second’s opportunity is not to replace calendars or task managers, but to become the **single trusted capture layer** that sits between the apps people already use and the productivity systems that help them remember.